“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Antya-līlā

Chapter 6

Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmī Meets Śrī Caitanya

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 I take refuge in Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, who by the ropes of His mercy cleverly lifted Raghunātha dāsa out of the blind well of a wretched household life, entrusted him to Svarūpa, and made him His intimate associate.

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra, and glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

3 In this way Gauracandra, together with His devotees, performed various pastimes in Nīlācala in many joyful ways.

4 Although separation from Kṛṣṇa afflicted Him within, He did not show it outwardly, for fear that His devotees would grieve.

5 But when the intense pain of separation broke out, the Lord’s agitation was beyond description.

6 Rāmānanda’s talks about Kṛṣṇa and Svarūpa’s singing kept the Lord alive in the pain of separation.

7 By day, in the company of various people, the Lord's mind was diverted; but at night His pain of separation grew.

8 For His happiness two persons stayed with Him and consoled Him with verses and songs about the sweet *rasa* of Kṛṣṇa.

9 As Subala formerly helped to make Kṛṣṇa happy, so Rāmānanda Rāya gave happiness to Gaura.

10 As Lalitā was formerly Rādhā's chief helper, so Svarūpa Gosāñi kept the Lord alive.

11 The good fortune of these two cannot be described: people praise them as the Lord's intimate associates.

12 In this way Gaura enjoyed His pastimes with His devotees. Now, O devotees, hear of His meeting with Raghunātha.

13 Earlier, when Raghunātha had come to Śāntipura, Mahāprabhu mercifully instructed him.

14 Following the Lord's instruction, he went home and, giving up *markaṭa-vairāgya* (monkey renunciation), lived outwardly like a worldly man.

15 Within he was detached, but outwardly he did all his duties; seeing this, his mother and father were glad at heart.

16 When he received news that the Lord had returned from Mathurā, he prepared to go to Him.

17 At that time there was a Muslim official of the province: he was the *caudhurī*, the revenue collector, of the Saptagrāma province.

18 Hiraṇya dāsa had taken the province on a permanent revenue lease (*makrari*). The official lost his authority, and seeing this he burned with resentment.

19 Hiraṇya collected twenty lakhs and paid the king twelve. Getting nothing, that “Turk” became his enemy.

20 He submitted a report (*kaiphiyat*) at the royal court and brought the vizier. Hiraṇya dāsa fled, and Raghunātha was arrested.

21 Every day he rebuked Raghunātha: “Bring your father and uncle, or you will suffer!”

22 Whenever he came to beat him, the sight of Raghunātha changed his heart, and he could not strike him.

23 Above all, knowing him to be a Kāyastha, he was afraid at heart: aloud he threatened and roared, but inwardly he feared to strike him.

24 Then Raghunātha thought of a plan and humbly spoke at that Muslim’s feet:

25 “My father and uncle are your two brothers. As brothers do, you are always quarreling.

26 Sometimes you quarrel, sometimes you are friends — nothing about it is fixed. Tomorrow the three brothers will be together again.

27 As I am my father’s child, so I am yours. I am your ward, and you are my protector.

28 It does not befit a protector to punish his ward. You know all the scriptures; you are like a *jindā pīr*, a living saint.”

29 Hearing this, the Muslim's heart melted; tears flowed down his beard, and he began to weep.

30 The Muslim said, "From today you are my son. Today I will get you released on some pretext."

31 He spoke to the vizier and had Raghunātha released. Then he began to speak to Raghunātha with affection:

32 "Your uncle is a fool: he enjoys eight lakhs himself. I am a sharer in it; he ought to give me something.

33 Go and bring your uncle to meet me. Let him do whatever is best — I leave it to him."

34 Then Raghunātha came and brought his uncle to meet him. He won the Muslim over, and everything was settled.

35 So a year of Raghunātha's life passed. In the second year he resolved to run away.

36 Rising at night, he ran away alone, but his father caught him far away and brought him back.

37 Again and again he fled, and each time they caught him and brought him back. Then his mother said to his father,

38 "Our son has gone mad. Keep him tied up." His father, dejected, replied to her:

39 "Wealth like Indra's and a wife like an *apsarā* — all this could not bind his mind.

40 How will you keep him with ropes? A father who gives birth cannot annul *prārabdha*, the fruit of past deeds that has begun to ripen.

41 Caitanyacandra's mercy has come upon him. Who can hold back a madman of Caitanya Prabhu?"

42 Then Raghunātha thought something over, and the next day he went to Nityānanda Gosāñi.

43 In the village of Pāṇihāṭī he had *darśana* of the Lord, who was accompanied by *kīrtana* singers, servants and many others.

44 On the bank of the Gaṅgā, at the foot of a tree, the Lord sat on a raised platform (*piṇḍā*), as if the sun were rising.

45 Many devotees surrounded Him, below and on the platform. Seeing the Lord's majesty, Raghunātha was astonished.

46 He fell flat like a rod at some distance, and a servant said, "Raghunātha is offering obeisance."

47 Hearing this, the Lord said, "You thief, so you have shown yourself! Come here, come here — today I will punish you!"

48 The Lord called him, but he did not come near. Then the Lord drew him close and placed His feet on his head.

49 Nityānanda, playful and merciful by nature, kindly said to Raghunātha:

50 "You don't come near, thief; you keep running far away. Today I have caught you, and I will punish you.

51 Feed My associates *dadhi* and *ciḍā*, yogurt and flat rice.” Hearing this, Raghunātha’s heart filled with joy.

52 At once he sent his men to the village, and they brought all kinds of food from there.

53 He had *ciḍā*, *dadhi*, milk, *sandeśa*, sugar and bananas brought, and he set them out all around.

54 Hearing the word “festival,” *brāhmaṇas*, gentlefolk and countless people began to arrive.

55 He brought more provisions from other villages and had two to four hundred clay pots (*holnā*) brought.

56 He also had five or seven very large earthen tubs brought, and in them one *brāhmaṇa* soaked *ciḍā* for the Lord.

57 In one place he soaked *ciḍā* in hot milk and mixed half of it with *dadhi*, sugar and bananas.

58 The other half he mixed with thickened milk, adding *cāṁpā* bananas, sugar, ghee and camphor.

59 When the Lord, wearing a *dhotī*, sat on the platform, the *brāhmaṇa* set the seven tubs before Him.

60 On the platform (*cabutarā*) all the Lord’s own associates and other eminent people sat in circles.

61 Rāmadāsa, Sundarānanda, Gadādhara dāsa, Murāri, Kamalākara, Sadāśiva, Purandara,

62 Dhanañjaya, Jagadīśa, Parameśvara dāsa, Maheśa, Gaurīdāsa, Kṛṣṇadāsa Hoḍa,

63 Uddhāraṇa Datta and all His other intimate associates sat on the platform. Who could count them?

64 Hearing of it, all the *brāhmaṇas* came — *paṇḍitas* and *bhaṭṭācāryas* — and the Lord honored them all and seated them on the platform.

65 Two earthen pots were set before each of them: in one, *ciḍā* with milk; in the other, *ciḍā* with *dadhi*.

66 All the other people sat in circles below the platform; there was no counting them.

67 Each person was given two pots, and *ciḍā* was soaked in them, with *dadhi* in one and with milk in the other.

68 Some *brāhmaṇas*, finding no place on the platform, went to the bank of the Gaṅgā and soaked their *ciḍā* there in two pots.

69 Others, finding no place even on the bank, went down into the water and ate their *ciḍā* and *dadhi* there.

70 Some were on the platform, some below it and some on the bank of the Gaṅgā, and twenty people served in all three places.

71 At that time Rāghava Paṇḍita arrived. Seeing all this, he was astonished and began to laugh.

72 He brought many kinds of *ni-sakḍi prasāda* (food untouched by boiled rice). First he gave it to the Lord; then he distributed it among the devotees.

73 He said to the Lord, “I offered food for You, but You are holding a festival here, and the *prasāda* remains at home.”

74 The Lord said, “Let Me eat this food by day; at night I will eat the *prasāda* in your house.

75 I am a cowherd by caste, and I have many cowherd boys with Me: I am happy in this sport of a picnic on the sandy riverbank.”

76 He seated Rāghava and had two tubs given to him, and Rāghava soaked two kinds of *ciḍā* in them.

77 When everyone’s *ciḍā* was ready, the Lord, in meditation, brought Mahāprabhu there.

78 Seeing that Mahāprabhu had come, Nitāi rose and, taking Him along, went to look at everyone’s *ciḍā*.

79 From every tub and pot He took a mouthful of *ciḍā* and, joking, put it into Mahāprabhu’s mouth.

80 Smiling, Mahāprabhu took another mouthful, put it into Nitāi’s mouth, and fed Him, laughing and laughing.

81 In this way Nitāi went round all the circles, and all the Vaiṣṇavas stood watching the fun.

82 No one understood what He was doing as He went about; only a fortunate few saw Mahāprabhu.

83 Then, smiling, Nityānanda sat down on His seat and kept four tubs of *āroyā-ciḍā* (flat rice made from sun-dried rice) at His right.

84 Giving Mahāprabhu a seat, He seated Him there, and then the two brothers began to eat *ciḍā*.

85 Seeing this, Nityānanda Prabhu was overjoyed and manifested many states of ecstasy.

86 He ordered, “Say ‘Hari!’ and eat!” The sound of “Hari! Hari!” rose up and filled the world.

87 Saying “Hari! Hari!”, the Vaiṣṇavas ate, and they all remembered the picnic on the sandy riverbank (*pulina-bhojana*).

88 Nityānanda and Mahāprabhu are merciful and generous: by Raghunātha’s good fortune They accepted so much.

89 Who can know Nityānanda’s power and mercy? He brought Mahāprabhu and made Him join the picnic on the riverbank.

90 Śrī Rāmadāsa and the other cowherd boys were overwhelmed with love: on the bank of the Gaṅgā they felt they were on the bank of the Yamunā.

91 Hearing of the festival, vendors (*pasāri*) came from various villages, bringing *ciḍā*, *dadhi*, *sandeśa* and bananas to sell.

92 Whatever goods they brought, he bought it all, paying the price; and having paid for their goods, he fed the vendors with them.

93 All the people who came to see the fun ate that *ciḍā*, *dadhi* and bananas.

94 When He had eaten, Nityānanda rinsed His mouth and hands (*ācamana*) and gave the remnants of the four tubs to Raghunātha.

95 There were remnants in the other three tubs, and the *brāhmaṇa* gave them to all the devotees, a mouthful to each.

96 A *brāhmaṇa* brought a flower garland and placed it around the Lord's neck; bringing sandalwood paste, he anointed His whole body.

97 A servant brought betel (*tāmbūla*) and offered it, and the Lord, smiling and smiling, chewed it.

98 With His own hand the Lord distributed to everyone what remained of the garlands, sandal paste and betel.

99 Delighted to receive the Lord's remnants (*śeṣa*), Raghunātha shared them with his own people and ate.

100 Thus I have told of Nityānanda's pastime, famous as the *ciḍā-dadhi-mahotsava*, the festival of *ciḍā* and *dadhi*.

101 The Lord rested, and when the day came to an end, *kīrtana* began in Rāghava's temple.

102 Nityānanda Rāya made all the devotees dance, and at last He Himself danced, flooding the world with love.

103 Mahāprabhu watched His dance; only Nityānanda saw Him — no one else did.

104 Nityānanda's dance was like Mahāprabhu's own dancing; in these three worlds there is nothing else to compare it with.

105 Who can describe the sweetness of that dance, which Mahāprabhu Himself comes to see?

106 When the Lord had danced and rested, the Paṇḍita asked Him to take His meal.

107 The Lord sat down to eat with His associates, having a seat spread for Mahāprabhu at His right.

108 Mahāprabhu came and sat on that seat; seeing this, Rāghava’s joy grew.

109 He brought *prasāda* and set it before the two brothers, and afterward he served all the Vaiṣṇavas.

110 There were many kinds of cakes (*piṭhā*), sweet rice (*pāyasa*), excellent fine rice, and various vegetable dishes that put nectar to shame.

111 The *prasāda* of Rāghava Ṭhākura is the very essence of nectar; Mahāprabhu comes again and again to eat it.

112 When Rāghava has cooked and places the offering before the Deity, he serves out a separate offering for Mahāprabhu.

113 Mahāprabhu eats there every day, and now and then the Lord lets Rāghava see Him.

114 Rāghava brought the meal and served the two brothers; he fed Them with care, and nothing was left over.

115 I cannot say how many dishes he brought. In Rāghava's house Rādhā Ṭhākurāṇī Herself cooks.

116 She received a boon from Durvāsā: Her cooking is sweeter than nectar.

117 The fragrant, beautiful *prasāda* was the very essence of sweetness, and the two brothers ate it with boundless satisfaction.

118 Everyone asked Raghunātha to sit down to the meal, but the Paṇḍita said, “He will eat later.”

119 The devotees ate their fill, up to the throat; then, calling out “Hari!”, they rose and rinsed their mouths and hands.

120 When the two brothers had eaten, They rinsed Their mouths and hands, and Rāghava brought garlands and sandal paste and adorned Them.

121 He gave Them *biḍā* (prepared betel) to chew and bowed at Their feet; then he gave the devotees *biḍā*, garlands and sandal paste.

122 Rāghava's mercy rested on Raghunātha: he gave him the plates with the remnants of the two brothers.

123 He said, “Caitanya Gosāñi has eaten from these. If you receive His remnants, your bondage will be cut.”

124 The independent Bhagavān always abides in the heart and in the home of His devotee — sometimes hidden, sometimes manifest.

125 The Lord is all-pervading; He dwells everywhere, always. Whoever doubts this goes to ruin.

126 In the morning Nityānanda Prabhu bathed in the Gaṅgā and sat with His associates at the foot of that same tree.

127 Raghunātha came and bowed at His feet, and through Rāghava Paṇḍita he humbly made his request:

128 “I am low and wretched, base, the lowest of souls. Yet my desire is to attain the feet of Caitanya.

129 It is like a dwarf wanting to catch the moon. I have tried many times, but never succeeded.

130 Every time I run away, leaving home and all, my father and mother both keep me bound.

131 Without Your mercy no one attains Caitanya; if You show mercy, even the lowest attains Him.

132 Unworthy as I am, I am afraid even to ask. O Gosāñi, be kind and grant me Caitanya.

133 Place Your foot on my head and grant me this grace; bless me, that I may attain Caitanya without obstacles."

134 Hearing this, the Lord smiled and said to all the devotees, "His worldly happiness equals the happiness of Indra.

135 Yet by Caitanya's mercy even that holds no charm for his mind. All of you, bless him, that he may attain the feet of Caitanya.

136 One who has caught the fragrance of Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet finds no charm in the happiness of Brahmaloka and the other worlds."

137 "Longing for Uttamaśloka, Bharata, while still young, cast off like so much filth his wife and sons, his friends and kingdom — all so dear to his heart and so hard to leave." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 5.14.43)

138 Then the Lord called Raghunātha near, placed His foot on his head and began to speak:

139 "To this picnic on the riverbank that you arranged, Gaura came to show you mercy.

140 In His mercy He ate *ciḍā* with milk, and at night, after watching the dancing, He partook of the *prasāda*.

141 Gaura came Himself to deliver you. All your bonds — obstacles and the rest — have been loosed.

142 He will entrust you to Svarūpa and keep you at His feet, calling you His intimate servant.

143 Go home free from care. Soon, without obstacles, you will attain the feet of Caitanya.”

144 Through all the devotees the Lord had him blessed, and Raghunātha bowed at the feet of them all.

145 Taking leave of the Lord and of the Vaiṣṇavas, he consulted with Rāghava in private.

146 After consulting him, he secretly placed a hundred coins and seven *tolās* of gold in the hands of the Lord's treasurer.

147 He told him, “Do not tell the Lord now; when He goes home, tell Him then.”

148 Then Rāghava Paṇḍita took him home, gave him *darśana* of the Deity, and gave him a garland and sandal paste.

149 He gave him plenty of *prasāda* to eat on the way. Then Raghunātha spoke again to the Paṇḍita:

150 “I wish to worship the feet of all the great souls, servants and dependents who are with the Lord.

151 Twenty, fifteen, twelve, ten or five — give the coins, considering how many befit each one.”

152 He drew up the whole account and gave it to Rāghava, and Rāghava had a list written of how much went to each name.

153 Humbly he placed a hundred coins and two *tolās* of gold before the Paṇḍita.

154 Taking the dust of his feet, he returned home; having received Nityānanda's mercy, he felt that his life had found its purpose.

155 From then on he did not go into the inner quarters of the house, but slept outside in the *durgā-maṇḍapa*.

156 There the guards all kept watch, while he thought of various ways to escape.

157 At that time all the devotees of Gauḍa set out for Nīlācala to see the Lord.

158 Raghunātha could not go with them: their company was well known and in plain sight, and he would have been caught at once.

159 While he was pondering this, one day, as providence would have it, he was sleeping outside in the *devī-maṇḍapa*.

160 When four *daṇḍas* of the night remained, Yadunandana Ācārya came in.

161 He had received the favor of Vāsudeva Datta; he was Raghunātha's guru and family priest (*purohita*).

162 He was an intimate disciple of Advaita Ācārya, and at the Ācārya's order he held Caitanya to be the treasure of his life.

163 When he came and stood in the courtyard, Raghunātha came and offered him obeisances.

164 A disciple of his, who served his Deity, had given up that service, and he had come to have him persuaded to return.

165 He said to Raghunātha, “Persuade him to do the service; there is no other *brāhmaṇa*.”

166 Saying this, he set off with Raghunātha. Toward the end of the night all the guards had fallen asleep.

167 The Ācārya's house lay to the east of Raghunātha's, and the two walked along that road, talking and listening.

168 Halfway there Raghunātha said at his guru's feet, “I will persuade that *brāhmaṇa* and send him to your house.

169 Go home in peace and give me leave.” Having begged leave on this pretext, he made up his mind:

170 “No servant, no guard — no one is with me. This is my chance to escape.”

171 Thinking this, he set off toward the east. He turned and looked back — no one was there.

172 Meditating on the feet of Śrī Caitanya and Nityānanda, he left the road and hurried along byways.

173 Avoiding the road that led from village to village, he went from forest to forest, meditating on the feet of Caitanya with body, mind and words.

174 In one day he walked fifteen *krośas*, and at dusk he stayed in a cowherd's cowshed.

175 Seeing that he was fasting, the cowherd brought him milk. He drank it and lay down there.

176 Back at home his servant and guard, not finding him, went to his guru and asked for news of him.

177 He said, “He asked my leave and went to his own home.” “Raghunātha has fled!” — an uproar arose.

178 His father said, “All the devotees of Gauḍa have set out for Nīlācala to see the Lord.

179 Raghunātha has run off with them. Ten men, go, catch him and bring him back!”

180 He humbly sent a letter to Śivānanda: “Please send my son back to me.”

181 The ten men went as far as Jhāṅkarā, and there they caught up with the party of Vaiṣṇavas.

182 They gave Śivānanda the letter and asked for news. Śivānanda said, “He has not come here.”

183 The ten men returned home, and his mother and father were deeply troubled.

184 Meanwhile Raghunātha dāsa rose at daybreak, left the eastward road and went on, turning south.

185 Past Chatrabhoga he left the main road and journeyed on from one poor village to another.

186 He gave no thought to food and walked all day long. Hunger did not trouble him, for his mind was set on attaining the feet of Caitanya.

187 Sometimes he chewed raw grain, sometimes he cooked, sometimes he drank milk; he kept himself alive on whatever came his way.

188 In twelve days he reached Śrī Puruṣottama; on the way he ate on only three days.

189 Gosāñi was sitting with Svarūpa and others when Raghunātha arrived and came before Him.

190 Keeping his distance in the courtyard, he bowed down. Mukunda Datta said, “Here is Raghunātha!”

191 The Lord said, “Come!” Raghunātha clasped His feet, and the Lord rose and mercifully embraced him.

192 He bowed at the feet of Svarūpa and all the devotees, and they all, seeing the Lord's mercy on him, embraced him.

193 The Lord said, “Kṛṣṇa's mercy is stronger than everything: it has snatched you out of the cesspit of worldly life.”

194 Raghunātha said to himself, “I do not know Kṛṣṇa. It is Your mercy that has snatched me out — this I know.”

195 The Lord said, “Your father and your uncle — because of their bond with Cakravartī, I regard both of them as My grandfathers (*ājā*).

196 Both are Cakravartī's ‘servants’, like brothers to him; that is why I joke about them.

197 Your father and uncle are worms in the cesspit of worldly stool: the great torment caused by the poison of sense objects they take for happiness.

198 Though they are devoted to *brāhmaṇas* and help them, they are not pure Vaiṣṇavas — only ‘almost Vaiṣṇavas’.

199 Still, it is the nature of worldly things to make one utterly blind; they make one do the very acts that bind one to the world of birth and death.

200 From such worldliness Kṛṣṇa has delivered you. The glory of Kṛṣṇa's mercy is beyond words.”

201 Seeing how thin and dirty Raghunātha was, the Lord, His heart melting with mercy, said to Svarūpa:

202 “I entrust this Raghunātha to you. Accept him as your son and your servant.

203 There are three named Raghunātha with Me; from today this one shall be called ‘Svarūpa's Raghu’.”

204 Saying this, He took Raghunātha by the hand and placed him in Svarūpa's hands.

205 Svarūpa said, “As Mahāprabhu commands,” and with these words he embraced Raghunātha again.

206 I cannot describe Caitanya's affection for His devotees. Showing mercy to Raghunātha, He said to Govinda:

207 “On the way he has fasted a great deal. For some days take good care of him.”

208 To Raghunātha He said, “Go and bathe in the sea; see Jagannātha, then come back and eat.”

209 Saying this, the Lord rose to perform His midday duties, and Raghunātha dāsa met all the devotees.

210 Seeing the Lord's mercy on Raghunātha, the devotees were amazed and praised his good fortune.

211 Raghunātha went to the sea and bathed, then saw Jagannātha and came back to Govinda.

212 Govinda gave him the Lord's plate of remnants, and he joyfully received the *mahā-prasāda*.

213 So he remained at Svarūpa's feet, and for five days Govinda gave him *prasāda*.

214 From the next day on, after seeing the *puṣpa-añjali*, the evening offering of flowers, he would stand at the Siṁha-dvāra to receive alms.

215 All the servants of Jagannātha are worldly householders (*viṣayīs*); when their service is finished, they go home at night.

216 Seeing Vaiṣṇavas at the Siṁha-dvāra in need of food, they kindly give them food from the vendors' stalls.

217 This has always been the custom: devotees who own nothing stand at the Siṁha-dvāra.

218 All day long these Vaiṣṇavas chant the holy name in *saṅkīrtana* and freely take *darśana* of Jagannātha.

219 Some beg at the *chatra* and eat whatever they get; others stand at the Siṁha-dvāra at night for alms.

220 Among Mahāprabhu's devotees renunciation comes first, and seeing it Gaura Bhagavān is pleased.

221 Govinda said to the Lord, “Raghunātha no longer takes the *prasāda*. At night he stands at the Siṁha-dvāra, begs and eats.”

222 Hearing this, the Lord was pleased, and at one point He said, “He has done well: he has followed the *dharma* of a renunciant.

223 A renunciant should always chant the holy name in *saṅkīrtana*, and he should keep himself alive by eating what he begs.

224 If one who has become a renunciant depends on others, he does not reach the goal, and Kṛṣṇa neglects him.

225 If one who has become a renunciant indulges the craving of the tongue, he loses the highest goal and falls under the sway of tastes.

226 The duty of a renunciant is to chant the holy name in *saṅkīrtana* always and to fill his belly with greens, leaves, fruits and roots.

227 One who runs here and there out of the tongue’s craving, devoted to the genitals and the belly, does not attain Kṛṣṇa.”

228 The next day Raghunātha came to Svarūpa's feet and inquired about his own duty:

229 "Why did He make me leave home? I do not know the purpose. What is my duty? May the Lord instruct me."

230 Before the Lord Raghunātha would not utter a single word; he had his own concerns told through Svarūpa and Govinda.

231 The next day Svarūpa made this submission before the Lord: "Raghunātha submits at the Lord's feet:

232 'What is my duty? I do not know the purpose. May You Yourself instruct me with Your own holy mouth.' "

233 Smiling, Mahāprabhu said to Raghunātha, "I have given you Svarūpa as your instructor.

234 Learn from him the truth of the goal (*sādhya*) and the means (*sādhana*). I do not know as much as he knows.

235 Still, if you have faith in My instruction, then hold firmly to these words of Mine.

236 Do not listen to worldly talk, and do not speak of worldly matters. Do not eat fine food, and do not wear fine clothes.

237 Seeking no honour yourself and giving honour to others, always chant the name of Kṛṣṇa, and within your mind serve Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa in Vraja.

238 Thus I have given you instruction in brief; you will learn it in full detail from Svarūpa.

239 “Lower than a blade of grass, more tolerant even than a tree, seeking no honour and offering honour to others, one should always sing the glories of Hari.” (Śikṣāṣṭaka, 3)

240 Hearing this, Raghunātha bowed down at the Lord’s feet, and Mahāprabhu mercifully embraced him.

241 Once more the Lord entrusted him to Svarūpa’s care, and together with Svarūpa he rendered intimate service (*antaraṅga-sevā*).

242 At that time all the devotees from Gauḍa arrived, and the Lord met them all as before.

243 Taking them all, the Lord cleansed the Guṇḍicā temple, and with them all He held a picnic in the garden.

244 At the Ratha-yātrā He danced together with them all, and seeing this Raghunātha was struck with wonder.

245 When Raghunātha dāsa met them all, Advaita Ācārya showed him great mercy.

246 Śivānanda Sena told him what had happened: “Your father sent ten men to fetch you.

247 He sent me a letter asking me to send you back. Not finding you, they turned back home from Jhāṙkarā.”

248 After staying four months, the devotees returned to Gauḍa. When Raghunātha’s father heard of it, he sent a man.

249 That man asked Śivānanda Sena, “At Mahāprabhu’s place did you see a Vaiṣṇava?

250 He is Govardhana's son, and his name is Raghunātha. Did you come to know him in Nīlācala?"

251 Śivānanda said, "He is with the Lord. He is very famous — who does not know him?

252 The Lord has entrusted him to Svarūpa's care, and to the Lord's devotees he is as dear as life.

253 Day and night he chants the holy name in *saṅkīrtana*, and not for a moment does he leave the Lord's feet.

254 His renunciation is complete: he has no concern for food or clothing. Eating whatever comes somehow or other, he keeps himself alive.

255 When ten *daṇḍas* of the night have passed, after seeing the *puṣpa-añjali*, he stands at the Siṁha-dvāra for food.

256 If someone gives him something, he eats; sometimes he fasts, and sometimes he chews parched grain."

257 Hearing this, the man went to Govardhana and told him all about Raghunātha.

258 Hearing it, his mother and father were grieved, and they sent goods and men to their son.

259 At once they sent four hundred coins, two servants and a *brāhmaṇa* to Śivānanda.

260 Śivānanda said, "You will not be able to go there by yourselves. When I go, you will go with me.

261 Go home now. When we all set out, I shall take all of you along with me."

262 In this connection Śrī Kavi-karṇapūra wrote of Raghunātha's glory at length in his book:

263 "The very gentle Yadunandana Ācārya is dear to Śrī Vāsudeva, and his disciple is Raghunātha, rich in virtues and dearer than life to people like us. By Śrī Caitanya's abundant mercy he is always tender with love; he is dear to Svarūpa and is the sole treasure-house of renunciation. Among those who live in Nīlācala, who does not know him?" (Śrī Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka, 10.3)

264 "He is a land of good fortune, pleasing to the minds of all people, a land that ripens without plowing: in it, at the very moment it was planted, the incomparable tree of love for Him bore fruit." (Śrī Caitanya-candrodaya-nāṭaka, 10.4)

265 Just as Śivānanda told that man, so Karṇapūra described him in these verses.

266 The next year Śivānanda set out for Nīlācala, and Raghunātha's servants and the *brāhmaṇa* went with him.

267 Bringing the four hundred coins, the *brāhmaṇa* and the servants came to Nīlācala and met Raghunātha.

268 Raghunātha dāsa would not accept it, so the two of them stayed there with the money.

269 Then, with great effort, Raghunātha began to invite the Lord twice a month.

270 The two invitations cost eight *paṇas* of cowries, and only that much would he accept from the *brāhmaṇa* and the servant.

271 He kept up these invitations for two years; then Raghunātha gave them up.

272 When Raghunātha had not invited Him for two months, the son of Śacī asked Svarūpa,

273 “Why has Raghu stopped inviting Me?” Svarūpa said, “He has thought something over in his mind:

274 ‘I take the money of worldly men and invite the Lord; I know the Lord’s mind — He is not pleased by this.

275 Taking this money, my heart does not become pure; I see that the only fruit of these invitations is prestige (*pratiṣṭhā*).

276 Out of regard for me the Lord accepts my invitation, for if He did not, this foolish person would be unhappy.’

277 Thinking this over, he gave up the invitations.” Hearing this, Mahāprabhu smiled and said,

278 “When one eats the food of worldly men, the mind becomes impure, and when the mind is impure, one cannot remember Kṛṣṇa.

279 An invitation with the food of worldly men is *rājasic*: the minds of both the giver and the eater become impure.

280 Out of regard for him I accepted for so many days. It is good that he has understood this and given it up himself.”

281 After some days Raghunātha gave up the Siṁha-dvāra and began to go to the *chatra*, beg and eat there.

282 Hearing of this from Govinda, the Lord asked Svarūpa, “Why does Raghu no longer stand at the Siṁha-dvāra for alms?”

283 Svarūpa said, “He felt distress at the Siṁha-dvāra; now he goes to the *chatra* at midday, begs and eats.”

284 The Lord said, “He has done well to give up the Siṁha-dvāra. To live by begging at the Siṁha-dvāra is the conduct of a prostitute:

285 ‘Here comes one — he will give; this one gave. Here another approaches — he will give. This one too gave nothing; another will come — he will give.’

286 But one who goes to the *chatra* fills his belly with whatever he gets; there is no other concern, and he happily chants Kṛṣṇa’s names in *saṅkīrtana*.”

287 Saying this, the Lord again showed him favour and gave him the *śilā* from Govardhana and the *guñjā* garland.

288 Śaṅkarānanda Sarasvatī had come from Vṛndāvana, bringing that *śilā* and *guñjā* garland with him.

289 The *guñjā* garland, strung at the side, and the *govardhana-śilā* — these two things he brought and presented to Mahāprabhu.

290 Receiving these two wonderful things, the Lord was pleased. At the time of His remembrance He would wear the *guñjā* garland around His neck.

291 The Lord would hold the *govardhana-śilā* to His heart and to His eyes; sometimes He would smell it, and sometimes He would place it on His head.

292 That *śilā* was always wet with the Lord's tears, and the Lord would call the *śilā* "Kṛṣṇa's own body."

293 So for three years He kept the *śilā* and the garland; then, pleased, He gave them to Raghunātha.

294 The Lord said, "This *śilā* is Kṛṣṇa's own Deity form. Serve Him eagerly.

295 Worship this *śilā* in the *sāttvic* way, and you will soon obtain the treasure of love for Kṛṣṇa.

296 A jug of water and *tulasī* buds (*mañjarīs*): this is *sāttvic* service, performed in a pure spirit.

297 On both sides, between two leaves, place a tender *mañjarī*; in this way offer eight *mañjarīs* with faith."

298 Giving him the *śilā* with His own holy hand, the Lord gave this order, and Raghunātha joyfully began his service.

299 Svarūpa gave him two cloths a span long, a small wooden seat and a jug for bringing water.

300 So Raghunātha performed the worship, and during the worship he saw in the *śilā* the son of the king of Vraja.

301 Thinking, "This *govardhana-śilā* was given by the Lord's own hand," Raghunātha was carried away in love.

302 The happiness that arose in this service with water and *tulasī* is not found even in worship with sixteen articles.

303 When he had worshipped in this way for some days, Svarūpa Gosāñi said to him,

304 “Offer *khājā* and *sandeśa* worth eight cowries. If you offer them with faith, they will be like nectar.”

305 From then on he offered *khājā* worth eight cowries, and by Svarūpa’s order Govinda arranged it.

306 When Raghunātha received the *śilā* and the garland, he reflected on what Gosāñi intended:

307 “By giving me the *śilā*, Gosāñi has entrusted me to Govardhana; by giving me the *guñjā* garland, He has given me to the feet of Rādhikā.”

308 In his bliss Raghunātha forgot the external world, and with body and mind he served the feet of Gaurāṅga.

309 Who can write of Raghunātha’s endless qualities? His rules of life were like lines cut in stone.

310 Seven and a half *praharas* went in chanting and remembrance; for eating and sleeping he allowed only four *daṇḍas*, and that only on some days.

311 The stories of his renunciation are wonderful to tell: from his birth he never let his tongue touch taste.

312 He wore no clothing but torn rags and a patched quilt, and so carefully kept the Lord’s order.

313 Whatever he ate merely to keep himself alive, he reproached himself after eating it.

314 “If one whose heart has been cleansed by knowledge truly knows the supreme Self, then, desiring what or for whose sake, would he pamper the body like a lecher?”

315 Whatever *prasāda* rice the vendors could not sell would begin to rot after two or three days.

316 They would throw that rice before the cows at the Siṁha-dvāra, but because of the rotten smell even the Telaṅga cows could not eat it.

317 Raghunātha would bring that rice home at night and wash it, pouring on a great deal of water.

318 The hard grains he found inside after scouring it, Raghunātha would eat with a little salt.

319 One day Svarūpa saw him doing this; smiling, he asked for some of it and ate it.

320 Svarūpa said, “Every day you eat such nectar and never give any to us! What kind of nature is that?”

321 The Lord heard this news from Govinda, and the next day He came and said,

322 “You all eat such excellent things — why do you not give Me any?” Saying this, He ate a mouthful.

323 As He was taking another mouthful, Svarūpa caught His hand, and saying, “This is not fit for You,” snatched it away by force.

324 The Lord said, “Every day I eat all kinds of *prasāda*, but I have never found such a taste in any other *prasāda*.”

325 In this way Mahāprabhu performed various pastimes, inwardly pleased to see Raghunātha’s renunciation.

326 Raghunātha dāsa himself has described his own deliverance in his *Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa*:

327 “Though I was fallen, He mercifully lifted me out of the forest fire of great wealth, entrusted me, wretched as I am, to His own Svarūpa, and was pleased. Though they were dear to Him, He gave me the *guñjā* garland from His chest and the *govardhana-śilā*. That Gaurāṅga, rising in my heart, maddens me.” (*Caitanya-stava-kalpavṛkṣa*, 11)

328 Thus I have told of Raghunātha’s meeting with the Lord. Whoever hears this attains the feet of Caitanya.

329 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.